# ADMIN PERSONA

## PERSONA SNAPSHOT

**Name:** Beth Miller
**Age:** 68
**Gender:** Female
**Location:** Adelaide, South Australia
**Occupation:** Retired (Volunteer Work)

## STORY

Beth Miller grew up in Redcliff, just north of Brisbane, in a working-class household. She was the second of three siblings, completing Year 12 in 1974, before meeting Robert, her now husband, at a church camping weekend. They got to know each other and quickly fell in love, getting married in 1978 at the age of 22, her husband 25. They built their life together in Redcliff, where Beth worked briefly as an office receptionist before Joe, their first child, arrived.

In 1990, Robert applied for and got accepted into a Director of Development role at the City of Adelaide Council. Although Beth was initially hesitant about this big move, she eventually gave in, and the two moved with their son Joe. Beth became a stay-at-home mum, and just 2 years after moving, had her second child, Kylie. As the household’s anchor, Beth managed the home, raising Joe and Kylie through school, engaging them in sport and music and building a new social network in Adelaide through the school’s parents and citizens association and her local Anglican church community.

Years passed, and Beth’s kids slowly moved out to start their own families. Robert retired, and Beth found herself rattling around a quiet house in the eastern suburbs of Adelaide. A neighbour mentioned that the local pet adoption centre was looking for volunteers. Beth, with time on her hands, signed up without hesitation and adopted a dog of her own, Biscuit the Golden Retriever. She quickly became a warm and reliable presence who was much loved in the community.

Beth was excelling in her new job, and because of this, she was asked to be an Admin on the new website. This new role required her to add and remove pets, update info, and mark adopted pets. Beth was nervous but willing. “I can give it a go, but don’t expect the world”, she said, panicking at just the thought of logging in.

## FAVOURITE TAG LINE’S

“I don't want to understand it, I just want to know that it helps.”

“I spent a lifetime caring for others. Not about to stop now.”

‘Over the years i’ve learnt that there is always a way to make things work, no matter how hard it may be”

## BUSINESS INTERACTION

- Volunteer at the local pet adoption centre, moving to Admin role on website.
- No formal background in web or digital admin control.
- Accesses the admin site 2-3 times per week, during daytime volunteer hours, on the work machine (listed in hardware)
- Tasks are narrow and recurring: add new pet listings, update existing listings, remove listings, mark pets as adopted, reply to adoption requests, message and log in and out.
- Has no involvement with settings, user management, or reporting.
- Engagmemt with the system is task driven, motviated by her want to help, not her want to learn or by any interest into the technology shes using.

## GROKABILITY ITEMS

- **Hobbies** — Loves her garden, tends to it most mornings. Participates in a weekly craft group with members from her church. Loves playing with Biscuit and watching him chase birds in the backyard. Prefers physical activity and nature over indoors and screens.
- **TV programs** — Watches the ABC evening news every night with Robert. She hates watching the news, but she knows how much Robert appreciates it when she watches it with her. Has no interest in streaming services, can't figure out how to work the smart TV without Robert's help. Sometimes they even need to call on their son Joe.
- **Fears** — Terrified of deleting things on technology, doesn't understand that most files go to a trash folder before being deleted. Worries she'll hold the centre back by being too slow or making mistakes. Doesn't like to ask for help in case she seems like a burden.
- **Goals** — Wants to feel genuinely useful now that the kids are gone. Hopes to get confident enough with the website that she doesn't need to call the coordinator.

## HARDWARE AND SOFTWARE USE

**HARDWARE:**

- Samsung Galaxy A15 smartphone. Used for calls, WhatsApp with family, and Facebook
- HP Pavilion personal laptop. Intel i5, 4GB RAM, used at home for general browsing and accessing the adoption centre admin site
- No desktop at home, but an old Windows 10 desktop at the centre. Intel i5 with integrated graphics, used during volunteer times to manage the website

**SOFTWARE:**

- Windows 10
- Google Chrome, browser on work desktop. Microsfot Edge, broswer on personal laptop
- Facebook. Used daily, one of her most familiar digital interfaces
- Gmail. Has an account, but finds it difficult to navigate and often misses emails
- WhatsApp. Comfortable using it for family group chats

## PERSONALITY CUES

- **The coordinator says…** "Beth is one of our most reliable volunteers, always showing up when she says she will and caring about every single animal."
- **Her kids say…** "Mum will figure it out eventually, she just panics first. Once she's done something a few times, she's fine"
- **Robert says…** "She's more capable than she gives herself credit for. She just doesn't trust herself with technology even though I tell her, 'You can't break it, love.'"
- **Pet peeve:** People who talk down to her or over-explain things slowly just because she's older.